

Vaio plays spoilt-sport

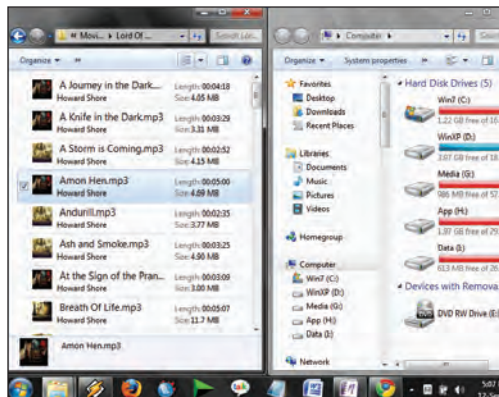
Sony's Vaio laptops will not be able to run Windows 7's "XP mode" because Sony disables the required hardware virtualisation features on its laptops

Microsoft's OEM charge

Microsoft recently revealed that it usually charges around \$50 for a Windows copy for a \$1000-PC built by an OEM



Using the [Win+Right/Left] combination to place application on half the screen.



Use the Windows + Space combination to hide applications and show the desktop



AeroShake feature. What it does is simple: shake the active window (the one you're using) and it hides all other windows. Shake it again and the windows are back to where they were. AeroShake software (Autohotkey script) for XP does the same! Pretty nifty replacement of the Windows + [D] key used to hide all windows, in case you just want to hide other inactive windows. And being another AutoHotKey script, it take very little RAM too. You can also customize a few options to choose number of shakes and behaviour with Extended displays.

[25.00] Skinning your Windows

This is something that need not be covered in detail, as Windows 7 looks pretty similar

to Windows Vista, and there's a plethora of software and themes available to give you a Vista or Windows 7 like looks.

Here are a few of the popular themes, each offering a few special features. There are also a few complete "Transformation Packs", but they're known to have bugs and are at times difficult to get rid of, so you should probably avoid them!

Remember to first patch the uxtheme.dll file before installing these new themes. Download UXTheme Patcher from <http://www.softpedia.com/> (Search for UX Theme, followed by your XP Service pack number).

- Windows 7 Complete by DopeySneezy: A complete theme replacement, with a replacement utility to allow you to backup all the system files you need to change. But

replacing is manual, so a little time consuming. <http://dopeysneezy.deviantart.com/art/Windows-7-Complete-109505907>

- Seven VG Theme by Vishal Gupta: A very popular theme by Vishal Gupta, who also runs a blog with a lot of other tweaks for Windows users (<http://www.askvg.com/>). Different parts of the themes are available as setups, which

make it easier to install.

http://www.deviantart.com/download/106952053/SevenVG_Refresh_with_Superbar_by_Vishal_Gupta.zip

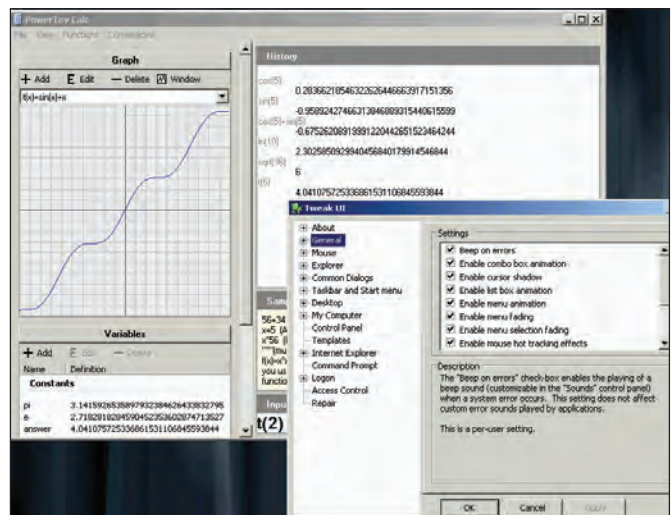
- CAD 2009 EDITION v1.5 by Flawless: For getting the Ctrl+Alt+Del screen in Windows 7 style, download this application. <http://flawless02.deviantart.com/art/CAD-2009-EDITION-v1-5-for-XP-132794740>
- Border Skin by Komalo: This only modifies the borders of the applications to give it an aero look. Though it has a few bugs yet to be fixed, it's surely worth giving a shot! <http://komalo.deviantart.com/art/Border-Skin-Aero-Glass-On-XP-119640021>

PowerToys from Microsoft

TweakUI allows you to change many features that are generally not available to customize in Windows XP. Similarly, there's a Power Calculator for advanced calculations (which beats even the Windows 7 calculator in functionality!).

PowerToys for XP: <http://www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/downloads/powertoys/xppowertoys.mspx>

These were few of the several third-party applications available that bring the best features of Windows 7 to your Windows XP. Choose the ones you need and enjoy the pleasure of Windows 7 while using Windows XP! **[1]**



Using Powertoys like Tweak UI & PowerCalculator to get more out of Windows XP

SHAKE OFF INACTIVE WINDOWS

Use AeroShake to hide all the windows except the one you're using, by merely shaking the titlebar. Shake it again to bring them back to where they all were.

Link: http://cache.gawker.com/assets/images/gawker/2008/11/Aero_Shake_1.3.exe